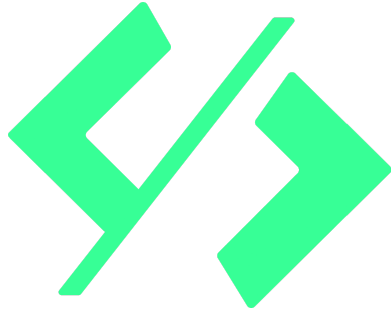




Longest Palindromic Substring

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Difficulty Level : Easy-Medium

Description

Given a string s , find the longest substring that is a palindrome. A string is a palindrome if it reads the same forwards and backwards.

Problem Statement

You are given a string s consisting of only lowercase English letters. Implement the function:

- **longestPalindrome(s):** Returns the longest palindromic substring found in s .

Rules

- A substring is a contiguous sequence of characters within the string.
- If multiple longest palindromes of the same length exist, return the first one that occurs.
- The palindrome must be at least one character long.

Constraints

- $1 \leq |s| \leq 1000$
- s consists of lowercase English letters only ('a' to 'z').

Examples

Example 1 - Simple Case

Input	Output
banana	anana

Explanation:

The longest palindrome is "anana", starting from index 1.

Example 2 - Same Length Palindromes

Input	Output
babab	bab

Example 3 - No Palindrome Longer Than One

Input	Output
abcde	a

Explanation:

No palindromic substrings longer than one character. The first letter is returned.